opportunity to prove their mettle and they will never let you down.

The other area of note was the Yangste sub-sector in the Kameng District of Arunachal, which had become part of 71 Infantry Division post its raising. This is an area which is critical to the defence of Tawang, though clearly South of the watershed still claimed by China. It is an isolated sub-sector and has to be maintained at full strength to avert any grab action by the PLA. The PLA does resort to some show of force and attempts to breach our forward defensive line, which is resolutely opposed. To press their claims, the strength of these patrols kept increasing, often striking at multiple points simultaneously. This could only be countered by having adequate strength of our own, and these attempts invariably resulted in some sort of scuffle, with the PLA invariably coming out second-best. This would only make them come with even more strength in the next attempt. One of the vulnerabilities of this sub-sector was that it was not connected by road. To induct any additional forces into this area, one had to go by road to Damteng, then by foot all the way up to the Yangtse Top and then forward to whichever location on the LAC needed to be reinforced. From Damteng, which was at an altitude of 10,000 ft, one had to ascend 5000 ft to reach the locations on the LAC, which were at heights ranging from 12,000 to 15,000 ft. In full battle gear and without oxygen, this could take anything between six to eight hours. Efforts at road construction had been underway since 2010 but had not made much headway as the track hit an unsurmountable rock face. That alignment had to be abandoned and a new one planned. Work commenced on this alignment, which could only be carried out in a limited working season. The Border Roads Organisation (BRO), which was entrusted with this task, made slow but steady progress and was finally able to

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